



VPA plans to further augment its container handling capacity through hinterland connectivity initiatives. With 170 ETKM track length, the port ensures robust evacuation. Continuous improvement of connectivity to national corridors under PM Gati Shakti and partnership with CONCOR for container logistics.

Q What are the recent infrastructure augmentation efforts at Visakhapatnam Port, and how do they align with operational efficiency goals?

Key projects include mechanization of EQ 2 to 5 and WQ 1 to 3 berths, development of hard-surface stack yards, and construction of dome-shaped covered sheds under the Pollution Mitigation Plan to ensure cleaner and faster cargo handling. Plans are also underway for a flyover within the port area (₹334 crore) to bypass 12 railway crossings and decongest traffic. In addition, the Port has sought Sagarmala 2.0 funding (₹3000 crore across 10 phases) for development of hard-surface stack yards, and construction of dome-shaped covered sheds and rail siding upgrades under pollution-control infrastructure. These initiatives will drastically cut turnaround and dwell times, enhance productivity & help VPA in becoming as a high-efficiency multimodal logistics hub.

Q Sustainability and green initiatives are becoming core to port management. How is VPA integrating ESG and clean port practices?

As India's Cleanest Major Port, VPA's action plan emphasizes mechanized cargo handling, dust-free enclosures, renewable energy, and water conservation. Under its green initiative roadmap, VPA is pursuing solar power expansion, electrification of equipment, and pollution mitigation through covered sheds and green belt development. VPA has taken up 1 Million plantations by 2027 as part of green initiatives involving Port stake holders, state government, NGO's etc. VPA has a capacity of 10MLD water treatment plant which is further proposed to augment to 15 MLD. Another 10 MLD is proposed at 2 different locations to completely avoid entering of sewage to harbour area. The port also aims to transition to electric tugs and implement zero liquid discharge systems, aligning with India's broader maritime decarbonisation and ESG goals.

Q How crucial is stakeholder coordination in VPA's operational success, and what mechanisms are in place to ensure alignment?

VPA's Regular review meetings with terminal operators, Indian Railways, Customs, and trade associations ensure real-time coordination, faster clearances, and synchronized cargo handling. Digital information-sharing systems and performance-based monitoring mechanisms have been institutionalized to sustain efficiency. By actively participating in PM Gati Shakti initiatives, VPA continues to align its multimodal logistics planning with national infrastructure development priorities, ensuring collective progress across stakeholders.

Q What are VPA's upcoming development plans, including port expansion, ship repair, or new ventures?

VPA has Expressed its Interest to the Government of Andhra Pradesh seeking strategic collaboration for the development

and operation of Mulapeta Port.

The Port is also pursuing acquisition of salt lands at Mulapeta for a Port-Based SEZ, over approximately 5,073 acres of salt lands at Naupada, close to Mulapeta Port. This SEZ will focus on multi-sector industrial development including steel, pharmaceuticals, green hydrogen, electronics, textiles, agro-processing, and integrated logistics. The proposed trunk infrastructure investment by VPA for development is about ₹1,500 crore, while private sector investments in various industries within the SEZ are estimated between ₹28,000 to ₹36,000 crores. This industrial cluster aims to generate around 6,000 direct jobs.

VPA also conducted technical study for establishment of Port cum ship building and ship repair cluster at Duggarajapatnam in collaboration with Government of Andhra Pradesh with an approximate cost of Rs.27, 000 Cr.

Q With India Maritime Week 2025 approaching, what can we expect from Visakhapatnam Port Authority's participation?

India Maritime Week 2025, scheduled in Mumbai from 27–31 October 2025, will be a landmark global forum for the maritime sector. VPA will showcase its clean port credentials, Cruise tourism, mechanization progress, and PPP success stories at the event. VPA's exhibits will focus on sustainability, smart operations, and port expansion plans, aligned with the Ministry's vision for green growth and modernization. The Port aims to leverage the platform for attracting investments in PPP projects, new collaborations for ship repair, and advancing its Smart Port Vision, reaffirming its leadership among Indian ports.

COMMUNITY CONNECT

Driving Inclusive Growth:

- VPA continues to lead with purpose, fostering inclusive growth through impactful CSR initiatives that benefit ethnic and coastal communities.
- Education, healthcare, and livelihood enhancement remain at the heart of VPA's community development efforts, reflecting responsible and sustainable port-led progress.
- 11th Greentech CSR India Awards 2025 in the categories of Skill Development and Healthcare, reaffirming VPA's benchmark status among India's Major Ports.
- Secured 1st Rank among all Major Ports in the Swachhata Pakhwada rankings, underscoring VPA's unwavering commitment to cleanliness, sustainability, and community well-being.

Digital Health Cards – A First Among Major Ports

- In a pioneering move, Shri Sarbananda Sonowal Ji, Hon'ble Minister for Ports, Shipping & Waterways, launched VPA's Digital Health Card initiative on 6th October 2025 — the first of its kind across all Major Ports in India.
- The Digital Health Cards provide a seamless, technology-driven healthcare solution for employees, pensioners, and their dependents. This single digital gateway ensures quick access to treatment at empanelled hospitals, promoting efficiency, transparency, and employee-centric care — redefining workplace wellness in the port sector.

Q How is Visakhapatnam Port Authority leveraging technology and smart systems to enhance efficiency and ease of doing business?

VPA is steering towards smart operations and technology-driven automation, as part of its "Smart Port" vision. The port's integrated digital systems ensure real-time visibility across vessel operations, cargo movement, and billing processes. Ports Master Plan vision 2047, submitted to the Ministry in October 2025, emphasizes full-scale digital integration through EBS and the National Logistics Portal–Marine, reducing transaction times and enhancing transparency. Adoption of modern monitoring systems, cargo scanners, RFID-enabled gates, Command Control Centre, and improved data analytics platforms are streamlining port operations, ensuring seamless coordination with customs, shipping agents, and terminal operators.

Q VPA has shown progress in container and clean cargo segments. What are the next steps to capture higher volumes and attract private participation?

The port's PPP/Captive/O&M framework, accounting for nearly half of its operations, has proven effective in ensuring efficiency and service reliability.